

MUS/AAS 262
JAZZ HISTORY: MANY SOUNDS, MANY VOICES

Instructor: Dr. Matthew Clayton
Email: mdc8@princeton.edu
Wednesday and Friday: 10:40am-12:00pm
Office Hours: By Appointment

Description:

This course examines the entire history of American jazz, from its beginnings at the dawning of the 20th century, up until its current realizations in the early 21st century. During this more than one hundred year period, jazz music has seen many different styles and innovators, and all of the major movements and voices in these movements will be considered and analyzed musically, historically, and culturally.

Readings:

Early Jazz, Gunther Schuller
Jazz 101, John Szwed
Saying Something, Ingrid Monson
Blues People, LeRoi Jones
Thinking In Jazz, Paul Berliner
Jazz, Scott Deveaux and Garry Giddins

Textbook

The primary text used in the class will be John Szwed's *Jazz 101*, Hachette Books, 2000.

Selected readings from the textbook are available on the course Canvas site. Please purchase the textbook to access all of the assigned readings from the Szwed book.

The other assigned readings will be available online on the course Canvas site. All readings are found under the "Reserves" tab on the Canvas website.

Listening:

Listening assignments will accompany each class, highlighting the reading material and giving experiential context for the music discussed and read about. The listening will focus on essential compositions and artists, giving the student a broad listening survey of the many sounds and voices within jazz during its century long history. The listening is posted on the course Canvas site, under the "Reserves" tab.

Assignments:

In addition to the listening assignments, there will be an emphasis on writing papers in this class. The midterm and final papers will allow the students to engage with the listening and reading material in a personal way, giving them the opportunity to express their ideas about given artists and movements in the jazz tradition. There will also be an oral presentation, where students will share their interests in the sounds that resonate with them the most.

Midterm Paper

The midterm paper will be a 5 page (double spaced) paper analyzing some aspect of the course, either a specific movement in jazz or an artist in that movement. Subject matter can include any material covered up until week 6, i.e. Early Jazz through Modal Jazz. Topics could include a critique of an album, artist profile with stylistic analysis, or another subject as approved by the instructor.

Final Paper

The final paper will be a 10 page (double spaced) research paper that can address any topic from class, from Early Jazz through 21st Century Modernists. This paper will require a thesis, and considerable research to support the chosen thesis. Citations are to be made in MLA Format.

Oral Presentation

Each student will be responsible for one 10 minute oral presentation. Topics will be approved by the instructor the week before the presentations (approval during the week of March 18th).

Quizzes

There will be two in class quizzes. These quizzes will test factual information about specific jazz movements covered in class, and they will also feature one listening example each for written analysis by the students on the quiz.

Class Participation

Although a lecture class, this course will allow for discussion and reaction to the many recordings and historical texts addressed. Students will frequently be asked to give feedback and respond to the various readings and performances covered.

Grading:

Midterm Paper: 20%

Final Paper: 30%

Class Participation: 20%

Oral Presentation: 15%

Quizzes: 15%

Goals:

1) Expose the student to the variety of sounds and styles within jazz; 2) give the student a historical framework for the music covered and discussed; 3) help the students develop a musical vocabulary.

Course Schedule

Week 1: Early Jazz

Wednesday, January 28, 2026

Readings:

Schuller, *Early Jazz*, The Origins (Chapter 1); The Beginnings (Chapter 2)

Jones, *Blues People*, African Slaves/American Slaves: Their Music (Chapter 3)

Friday, January 30, 2026

Readings:

Schuller, *Early Jazz*, The First Great Soloist (Chapter 3)

Szwed, *Jazz 101*, 1900-1925: New Orleans (Chapter 12)

Listening Assignments: Scott Joplin, Jelly Roll Morton, W.C. Handy, Bessie Smith, Louis Armstrong

Scott Joplin, "Maple Leaf Rag" (1916, Piano Roll)

W.C. Handy, "St. Louis Blues" (1922)

Original Dixieland Jazz Band, "Dixie Jass Band One-Step" (1917)

Bessie Smith, "Backwater Blues" (1927)

Jelly Roll Morton, "Dead Man Blues" (1926)

Louis Armstrong, "West End Blues" (1928) from *Louis Armstrong and His Hot Five*

Week 2: The Big Bands

Wednesday, February 4, 2026

Readings:

Schuller, *Early Jazz*, Ellington (Chapter 7)

Szwed, *Jazz 101*, 1925-1940: Swing (Chapter 14)

Friday, February 6, 2026

Readings:

Jones, *Blues People*, Swing – From Verb to Noun (Chapter 10)

DeVeaux and Giddins, *Jazz*, A World of Soloists (Chapter 9)

Listening Assignments: Count Basie, Duke Ellington, Coleman Hawkins, Billie Holiday, Ella Fitzgerald

Duke Ellington, "Take the A Train" (1941)

Duke Ellington, "Cotton Tail" (1940)

Count Basie, "One O'Clock Jump" (1937)

Count Basie/Lester Young, "Oh! Lady Be Good" (1936)

Coleman Hawkins, "Body and Soul" (1939)

Benny Goodman, "Sing Sing Sing" (1937)

Billie Holiday, "God Bless the Child" (1942)

Ella Fitzgerald, "Blue Skies" from *Ella Fitzgerald Sings the Irving Berlin Songbook*

Week 3: Bebop

Wednesday, February 11, 2026

Readings:

Szwed, *Jazz 101*, Five Who Helped Make a Revolution (Chapter 16)

Friday, February 13, 2026

Readings:

Jones, *Blues People*, The Modern Scene (Chapter 12)

Listening Assignments: Charlie Parker, Dizzy Gillespie, Bud Powell

Charlie Parker and Dizzy Gillespie, "Dizzy Atmosphere" (Live) from *Diz N' Bird at Carnegie Hall*

Charlie Parker, "Ko Ko" from *The Complete Savoy Recordings*
Charlie Parker, "Parker's Mood" from *The Complete Savoy Recordings*
Bud Powell, "Tempus Fugue-it" from *Jazz Giant*

Week 4: Bebop, Continued

Wednesday, February 18, 2026

Readings:

Szwed, *Jazz 101*, Bebop (Chapter 17)

Friday, February 20, 2026

Quiz #1

Readings:

Berliner, *Thinking In Jazz*, Introduction: Picking Notes out of Thin Air?

Listening Assignments: Thelonious Monk, Sonny Stitt, Dexter Gordon
Thelonious Monk, "Criss Cross" from *Genius of Modern Music, Vol. 2*
Thelonious Monk, "Round Midnight" from *Thelonious Himself*
Sonny Stitt, "Cherokee" from *Kaleidoscope*
Dexter Gordon, "Long Tall Dexter" from *Settin' the Pace*

Week 5: Hard Bop

Wednesday, February 25, 2026

Readings:

DeVeaux and Giddins, *Jazz*, The 1950s: Cool Jazz and Hard Bop (Chapter 12)

Friday, February 27, 2026

Readings:

Monson, *Saying Something*, Music, Language, and Cultural Styles (Chapter 3)
Szwed, *Jazz 101*, Hard Bop, Soul Music, and Funk (Chapter 20)

Listening Assignments: Art Blakey, Horace Silver, Sonny Rollins, Miles Davis, John Coltrane
Art Blakey, "Blues March" from *Moanin'*
Horace Silver, "Song For My Father" from *Song for My Father*
Sonny Rollins, "St. Thomas" from *Saxophone Colossus*
Miles Davis, "Boplicity" from *Birth of the Cool*
Miles Davis, "Oleo" from *Relaxin' With the Miles Davis Quintet*
Cannonball Adderley, "Sack O' Woe" from *At the Lighthouse*
Charles Mingus, "Better Git It in Your Soul" from *Mingus Ah Um*
John Coltrane, "Giant Steps" from *Giant Steps*

Week 6: Modal Jazz

Wednesday, March 4, 2026

Szwed, *Jazz 101*, Post-Bebop Improvisation, c. 1956 (Chapter 22); 1959: Multiple Revolutions (Chapter 23)

Friday, March 6, 2026

Readings:

Berliner, *Thinking In Jazz*, A Very Structured Thing (Chapter 3)

Midterm Paper Due

Listening Assignments: Miles Davis, John Coltrane, Bill Evans, Dave Brubeck, Joe Henderson, Wayne Shorter

Miles Davis, "So What" from *Kind of Blue*

Miles Davis, "Riot" from *Nefertiti*

John Coltrane, "My Favorite Things" from *My Favorite Things*

Bill Evans, "Nardis" from *Explorations*

Dave Brubeck, "Take Five" from *Time Out*

Herbie Hancock, "Maiden Voyage" from *Maiden Voyage*

Stan Getz, "The Girl from Ipanema," from *Getz/Gilberto*

Andrew Hill, "Refuge" from *Point of Departure*

Joe Henderson, "Serenity" In *'N Out*

Wayne Shorter, "Speak No Evil" from *Speak No Evil*

John Coltrane, "Acknowledgment" from *A Love Supreme*

Week 7: Free Jazz

Wednesday, March 18, 2026

Readings:

Szwed, *Jazz 101*, Free Jazz (Chapter 24)

Friday, March 20, 2026

Readings:

Szwed, *Jazz 101*, The 1970s (Chapter 26)

Listening Assignments: Ornette Coleman, Cecil Taylor, Eric Dolphy, John Coltrane, Albert Ayler

Ornette Coleman, "Lonely Woman" from *The Shape of Jazz to Come*

Cecil Taylor, "Tales (8 Whisps)" from *Unit Structures*

Eric Dolphy, "Straight Up and Down" from *Out to Lunch*

Albert Ayler, "Ghosts" from *Spiritual Unity*

John Coltrane, "Expression" from *Expression*

Week 8: the 1980s

Wednesday, March 25, 2026

Oral Presentations

Friday, March 27, 2026

Quiz #2

Readings:

Szwed, *Jazz 101*, The 1980s and 1990s (Chapter 28); DeVaux and Giddins, *Jazz*, Historicism: Jazz on Jazz (Chapter 18)

Listening Assignments: Wynton Marsalis, Branford Marsalis, Michael Brecker, Steve Coleman
Wynton Marsalis, "Delfeayo's Dilemma" from *Black Codes*
Wynton Marsalis, "The Autumn Leaves" from *Marsalis Standard Time Vol. 1*
Michael Brecker, "Syzygy" from *Michael Brecker*
Branford Marsalis, "Yes and No" from *Random Abstract*
Steve Coleman, "Irate Blues" from *Motherland Pulse*

Week 9: Oral Presentations

Wednesday, April 1, 2026

Oral Presentations

Friday, April 3, 2026

Oral Presentations, Cont.

Week 10: the 1990s

Wednesday, April 8, 2026

Oral Presentations

Friday, April 10, 2026

Readings:

Berliner, *Thinking In Jazz*, Epilogue: Jazz as a Way of Life; Szwed, *Jazz 101*, What's Next? (Chapter 31)

Listening Assignments: Joshua Redman, Roy Hargrove, Brad Mehldau, Chris Potter, Kenny Garrett
Joshua Redman, "Rejoice" from *Mood Swing*
Kenny Garrett, "2 Down & 1 Across" from *Songbook*
Chris Potter, "This Will Be" from *Vertigo*
Brad Mehldau, "Nice Pass" from *Warner Jams Vol. 1*
Roy Hargrove, "Never Let Me Go" from *With the Tenors of Our Time*

Week 11: The Roots of Jazz Fusion and the Dawning of the 21st Century

Wednesday, April 15, 2026

Oral Presentations

Friday, April 17, 2026

Readings:

DeVeaux and Giddins, *Jazz*, Fusion II (Chapter 17); Szwed, *Jazz 101*, Jazz-Rock (Chapter 27)

Listening Assignments: Miles Davis, Herbie Hancock, Weather Report, A Tribe Called Quest, the Roots, D'Angelo, Robert Glasper, Esperanza Spalding
Miles Davis, "Bitches Brew" from *Bitches Brew*
Herbie Hancock, "Watermelon Man" from *Head Hunters*
Grover Washington, Jr., "Winelight" from *Winelight*
Weather Report, "Birdland" from *Heavy Weather*

A Tribe Called Quest, "Check the Rhime" from *The Low End Theory*
Steve Coleman, "The Tao of Mad Phat" from *The Tao of Mad Phat*
The Roots, "Essaywhuman?!!!?!?" from *Do You Want More?!!?!?*
D'Angelo, "Brown Sugar" from *Brown Sugar*
Robert Glasper, "Afro Blue" from *Black Radio*
Esperanza Spalding, "Precious" from *Esperanza*

Week 12: 21st Century Modernists

Wednesday, April 22, 2026

Oral Presentations

Friday, April 24, 2026

Readings:

DeVeaux and Giddins, *Jazz Today* (Chapter 19)

Wrap-up and Final Thoughts

Listening Assignments: Mark Turner, Kurt Rosenwinkel, the Bad Plus, Jason Moran, Brian Blade Fellowship

Mark Turner, "Iverson's Odyssey" from *Dharma Days*

Kurt Rosenwinkel, "Zhivago" from *The Next Step*

Brian Blade Fellowship, "Crooked Creek" from *Perceptual*

Jason Moran, "Ringing My Phone (Straight Outta Istanbul)" from *The Bandwagon*

The Bad Plus, "Seven Minute Mind" from *Made Possible*

Final Paper Due Sunday, May 10, 2026 by 7:00pm